

didn't have to sacrifice lifestyle, trading a 600-square-foot one-bedroom condo on Long Island for a two-bedroom place in Charlotte. According to Mr. Groovy, "I gave up nothing. The weather is nicer. The core government services are just as good as Long Island. I do the same thing in North Carolina as I did on Long Island."

Brad

When my wife and I got married in late 2005 we realized we truly wanted something different, so we decided to leave our high cost of living area on Long Island, NY and move to Richmond, VA. Even though we were both CPAs and could "succeed" on Long Island using traditional measures, we always felt we'd have to give something up (e.g., saving for retirement, travel, Laura staying home with our future kids, etc.), and we weren't prepared to mortgage our future and our freedom. So we made the tough decision to leave our family and friends and move 400 miles south, where the housing prices were over 50 percent less than Long Island. That one decision catapulted us on the path to FI.